

BIG 2

Also known as Deuces, Pusoy Dos, or Chinese Poker. A climbing card game for exactly four players. Each player receives 13 cards and tries to be the first to empty their hand by playing progressively higher combinations.

SETUP

- ♦ 4 players. Deal all 52 cards evenly (13 each).
- ♦ Player with the 3 of Diamonds leads the first round.
- ♦ Subsequent rounds: loser of previous round leads.

CARD RANKING

Rank (low to high): 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, J, Q, K, A, 2

Suit (low to high): Diamonds, Clubs, Hearts, Spades

The 2 of Spades is the highest card in the game.

COMBINATION TYPES

TYPE	CARDS	RANKING
Single	1 card	By rank, then suit
Pair	2 same rank	By rank of pair, then highest suit
Triple	3 same rank	By rank
Five-card hand	5 cards	By poker hand type, then by highest card

Five-card hand ranking (low to high): Straight, Flush, Full House, Four of a Kind, Straight Flush, Royal Flush.

RULES

- 1 Lead player plays any valid combination.
- 2 Each subsequent player must play the same combination type at a higher value, or pass.
- 3 When all other players pass, the last player who played leads the next trick.
- 4 The first player to empty their hand wins.
- 5 Remaining players are ranked by finishing order.

PASSING

A player who passes may play again when the turn comes back around (unless the trick is already won). Passing is strategic, not permanent.

ATTRIBUTION

Big 2. Traditional Chinese climbing card game, widespread across East and Southeast Asia. Public domain. Rules confirmed from Pagat.com and Wikipedia.

PRESIDENT

Also known as Scum, Asshole, or Capitalism. A multi-round climbing card game where finishing position in each round determines your role (and advantages) in the next.

SETUP

- ♦ 4 to 8 players
- ♦ Standard 52-card deck (no jokers), dealt evenly (discard remainders or give to President)
- ♦ First round: player with 3 of clubs leads. Subsequent rounds: Scum leads

ROLES (FROM PREVIOUS ROUND)

POSITION	ROLE	ADVANTAGE
1st out	President	Receives 2 best cards from Scum
2nd out	Vice President	Receives 1 best card from Vice Scum
2nd last	Vice Scum	Gives 1 best card to Vice President
Last out	Scum	Gives 2 best cards to President

Middle positions (in 5+ player games) have no trading obligation.

RULES

- 1 Lead player plays any valid combination (single, pair, triple, or sequence)
- 2 Each subsequent player must play the same combination type but higher value, or pass
- 3 When all players pass consecutively, the last player who played leads the next trick
- 4 First player to empty their hand finishes 1st, second finishes 2nd, etc.
- 5 Round ends when all but one player has emptied their hand — that player is Scum
- 6 Roles are assigned based on finishing order
- 7 Card trading occurs before the next round begins
- 8 Game continues for a set number of rounds or until a player accumulates enough “President” wins

CARD RANKING

2 > A > K > Q > J > 10 > 9 > 8 > 7 > 6 > 5 > 4 > 3

(Same as Big 2 — 2 is highest)

KEY DIFFERENCES FROM BIG 2

CONCEPT	BIG 2	PRESIDENT
Players	4 (fixed)	4–8 (variable)
Rounds	Single	Multi-round with persistent roles
Card trading	None	Forced exchange based on roles
Who leads	3 of diamonds	Scum (lowest rank)
Win condition	First to empty hand	Accumulate President wins
Deck	Standard 52	Standard 52 (split evenly)
Combinations	Singles, pairs, 5-card hands	Singles, pairs, triples, sequences

WHY THIS TESTS THE ENGINE

President forces the engine to handle:

- ♦ **Multi-round persistence** — roles and scores carry between rounds
- ♦ **Asymmetric card dealing** — trading phase modifies hands before play
- ♦ **Variable player count** — same rules scale from 4 to 8
- ♦ **Role-based turn order** — who leads depends on previous round outcome
- ♦ **State between rounds** — not just within a single game
- ♦ **Component interaction** — deck (deal) + player state (roles) + game flow (rounds)